

China Macro Tracker

Economics China

Expanding consumption, led by services

- ◆ The 15th FYP for consumption targets 3.7% retail sales CAGR, but the priority is on services consumption expansion
- ◆ Green transition to accelerate via faster non-fossil fuel targets and grid upgrades
- ◆ Fiscal policy likely a key focus for the July Politburo meeting; monetary policy to remain supportive through targeted measures

Blueprint for expanding consumption: services to drive growth

On 13 July, Premier Li Qiang chaired a symposium with economists and entrepreneurs, signalling policy priorities for the second half of the year: 1) boosting consumption, with a particular focus on services; 2) driving investment through major infrastructure network projects and improved livelihoods; and 3) supporting employment to strengthen household income prospects and consumer confidence.

The State Council also released the 15th Five-Year Plan (FYP) for expanding consumption, with the goal to significantly increase household consumption, while targeting retail sales to reach around RMB60trn by 2030 (State Council, 13 July), implying a CAGR of 3.7% in nominal terms. However, retail sales grew 1.4% y-o-y in January-May (chart 1), highlighting short-term cyclical pressures. With trade-in support fading, and weakness in the property and labour market, household consumption remains cautious ([China's cautious consumer](#), 22 May).

The plan gives prominent emphasis to expand services consumption, highlighting the need to raise the share of services spending (chart 2-3). Key priority areas include elderly care, childcare, culture and tourism, health, and sports. Previous guidance on advancing the services sector set a goal of increasing the total size of services consumption to RMB100trn by 2030 (CAGR of 4.6%). Together with further opening of the services sector, high-quality services supply could help to drive its growth.

While the property market has improved in tier-1 cities, broader improvement has yet to occur (chart 12-16). A weak property market not only suppresses consumption in the property value chain but also weighs on household willingness to spend via wealth effects. The plan emphasises optimising the supply of affordable housing and advancing urban renewal, which could help to stabilise the sector. In our view, new urbanisation could add 0.8-1.3ppt of consumption spending to annual GDP by 2030 (see [China's Urbanisation 2.0](#), 29 May).

Stabilising employment and income are also key priorities. Building on the 15th FYP for implementing the employment-first strategy ([China Macro Tracker](#), 10 June), the consumption plan further highlights multiple channels to raise incomes, including improving the adjustment mechanism for minimum wages and increasing property income (supported by a healthier property market and a steady capital market), to enhance the household income outlook and strengthen consumer confidence.

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**2026 Extel Global Fixed-Income
Research Survey**

6 – 24 July

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Green transition: acceleration expected, more detailed targets unveiled

The 15th FYP, released in March, set the headline goal of lifting non-fossil energy to 25% of total energy consumption by 2030 (from 21.7% in 2025), implying an average 0.66ppt increase per year. Recent policy guidance suggests the momentum will likely accelerate early in the 15th FYP period. On 10 July, the National Energy Administration released its 2026-28 Action Plan on energy conservation and carbon reduction for the energy sector, setting a more ambitious target to lift the share of non-fossil energy consumption by c1ppt each year to 2028 (Xinhua, 10 July).

Meanwhile, to help accelerate optimisation of the energy mix, the State Council released the 15th FYP carbon-peaking action plan on 9 July and set out more granular targets. For one, non-fossil fuel capacity should continue to expand in the next five years, based on explicit installed-capacity objectives for wind, solar, nuclear, and hydropower by 2030 (chart 6). However, following the strong build-out of recent years, growth is expected to moderate for major sources. For instance, combined wind and solar installed capacity increased by 360GW in 2024 and 440GW in 2025, while the plan now targets around 200GW of annual additions during the 15th FYP period. Instead, policy priorities are shifting towards encouraging technological breakthroughs, curbing involutionary competition and phasing out outdated capacity.

In addition, as noted by HSBC's Chief Asia Economist Fred Neumann, et al., China's seemingly low share of renewables in the energy consumption mix – despite substantial capacity additions in recent years – partly reflects capacity that is not yet fully connected to the grid; once it is, the share should materially increase (see [Asia Chart of the Week: Beyond Hormuz](#), 10 July). At end-2025, non-fossil fuel energy (including green, nuclear, and hydro power) accounted for 21.7% of China's total energy consumption (NEA, 24 April). The plan's emphasis on enhancing the existing power system's capability to integrate, allocate, and manage renewable energy resources, enhance cross-region transmission capabilities, and develop long-duration power storage is a step in the right direction.

A further priority is linking computing facilities with clean energy. With AI demand expected to remain strong, electricity consumption will likely continue to rise. Although coal still provides more than half of China's power generation, China plans to lift the share of non-fossil sources to 50% by 2030, from 42.3% in 2025. To help achieve that, the plan explicitly promotes using primarily non-fossil fuel electricity to supply newly built computing power facilities.

Fiscal policy could accelerate; PBoC Q2 MPC highlights targeted monetary support

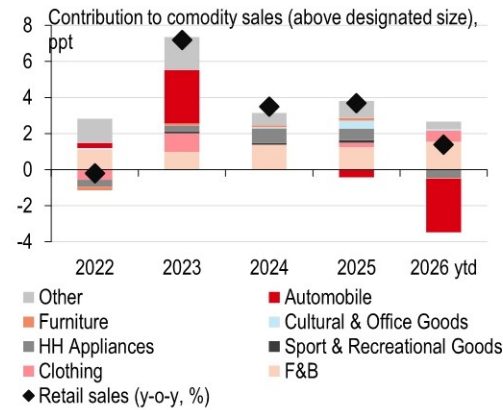
Recent data showed exports continued to provide support for growth ([China trade](#), 14 July), although we expect that domestic demand remained soft for the June print. With GDP growth likely to take a step back from Q1's outperformance (we expect 4.6% y-o-y), there will likely be more focus on policymakers' response. More attention will be placed on the July Politburo meeting, which typically occurs at month-end and emphasizes the economic progress in H1, while providing economic policy guidance for H2. We expect guidance around accelerated implementation of fiscal policy (e.g. special local government bond issuance) and the use of existing tools such as the new financing policy tools.

Meanwhile, monetary policy is likely to remain supportive through liquidity and targeted easing, although we do not expect further policy rate cuts. The PBoC's Q2 MPC meeting readout was broadly consistent with Q1, reiterating a moderately loose monetary policy stance and increasing counter-cyclical and cross-cyclical policy adjustments (PBoC, 8 July).

However, the Q2 meeting introduced phrasing about structural divergence in the economy, which suggests the PBoC is paying attention to the increasingly K-shaped growth trajectory, with resilient exports and strong domestic industrial upgrading, but weakness in consumption and investment. Similar to Q1, the PBoC pledged to use structural tools to support domestic demand, technological innovation, and small and medium-sized enterprises.

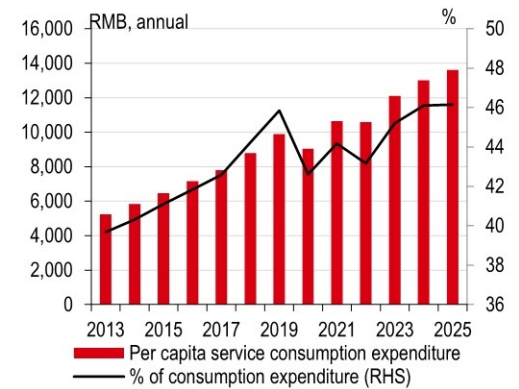
Charts of the week

1. Retail sales under pressure, with automobiles the main drag



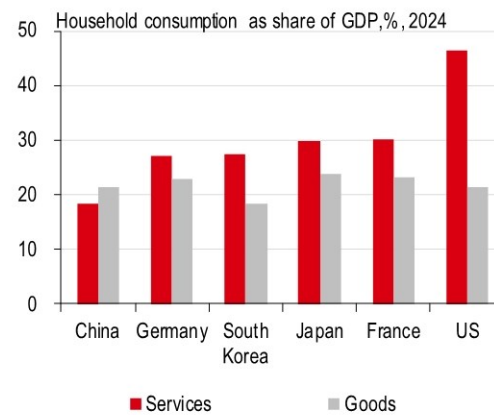
Source: Wind, HSBC; Note: YTD is through May 2026

2. The share of services consumption in household consumption expenditure rose



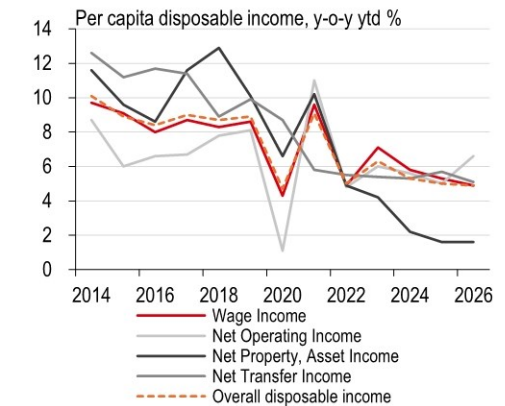
Source: CEIC, HSBC

3. There is ample room for growth in services consumption



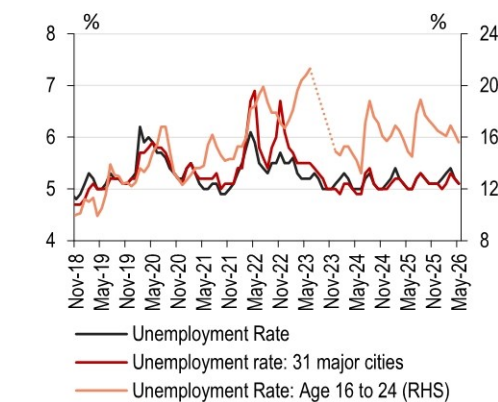
Source: CEIC, HSBC

4. Slowing income growth weighed on consumption



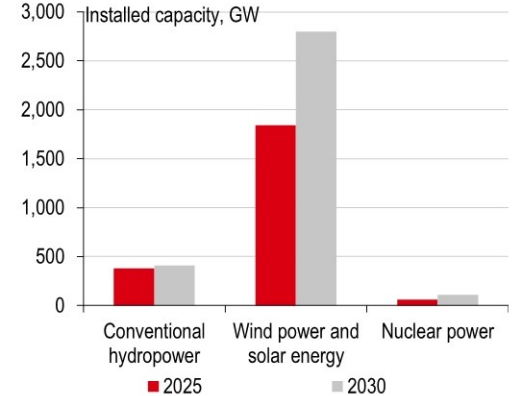
Source: Wind, HSBC

5. The labour market remains under pressure



Source: Wind, HSBC

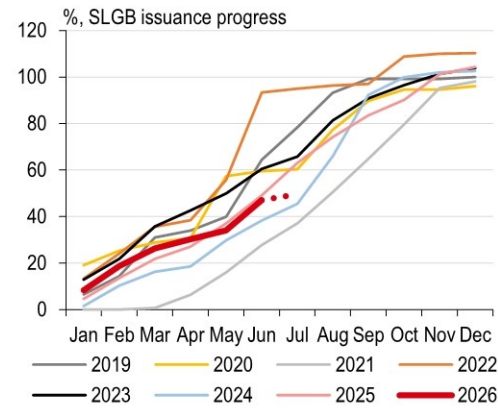
6. Energy mix will keep improving, with a higher share of renewable capacity



Source: 15th FYP carbon-peaking action plan, HSBC

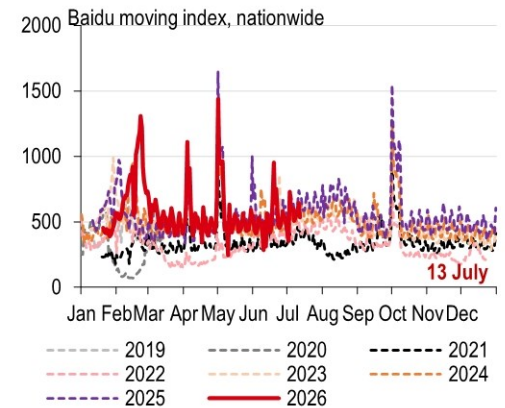
Economic activity

7. LGSB issuance can be stepped up to support infrastructure investment



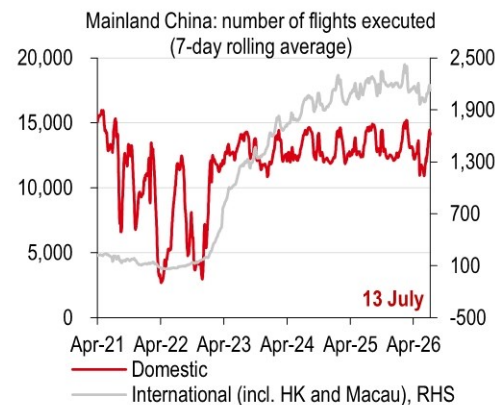
Source: Wind, HSBC; Note: Data as of 14 July.

8. Cross-city travel remained elevated



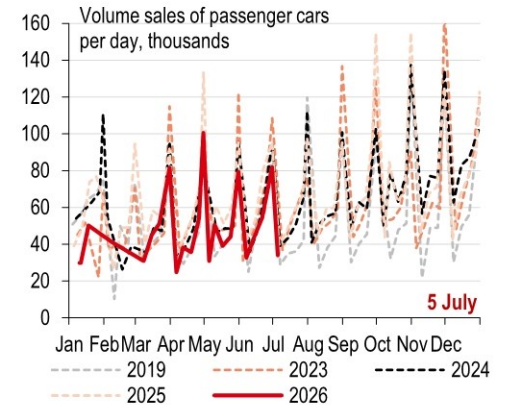
Source: Baidu Index, HSBC

9. The number of domestic flights moved up



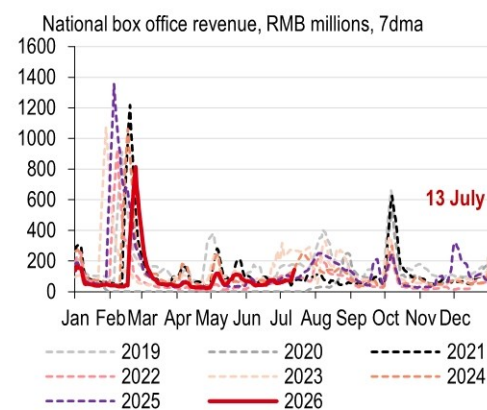
Source: Wind, HSBC

10. Car sales edged down in July in year-on-year terms



Source: Wind, HSBC

11. National box office revenues edged up



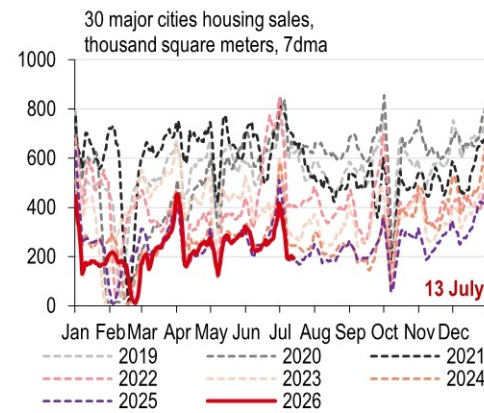
Source: Wind, HSBC

12. Housing prices in tier-1 cities edged up



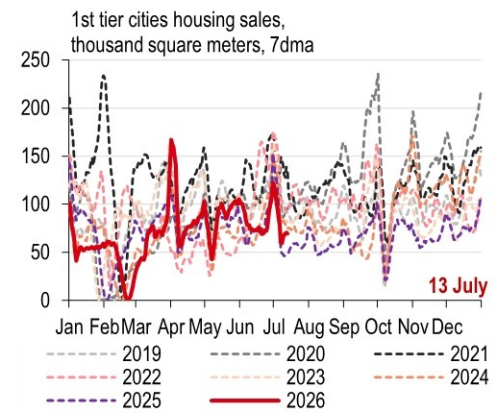
Source: Bloomberg, HSBC; Note: as of 14 July.

13. New home sales edged down seasonally



Source: Wind, HSBC

14. New home sales in Tier-1 cities remained higher y-o-y



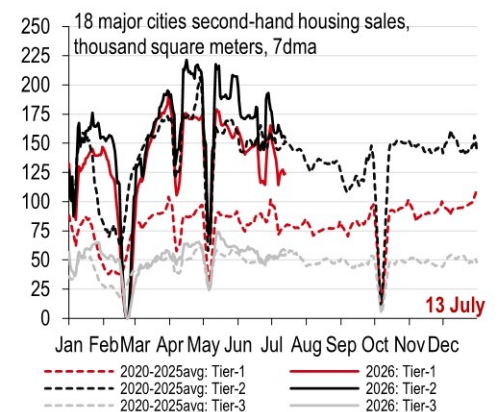
Source: Wind, HSBC

15. Second-hand home sales in 18 major cities eased seasonally



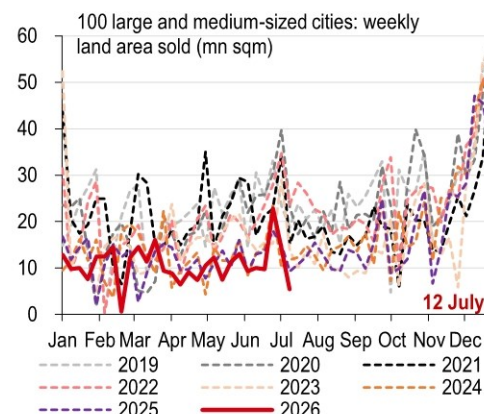
Source: Wind, HSBC

16. Transactions in second-hand homes in Tier-2 cities remained higher y-o-y



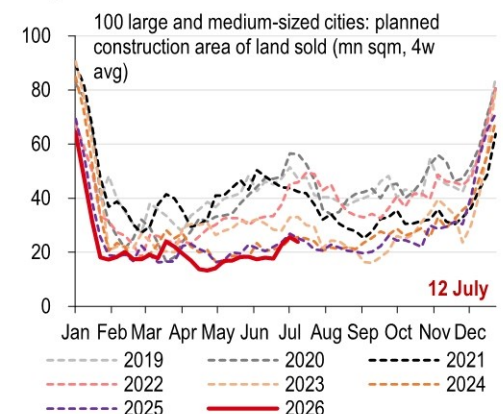
Source: Wind, HSBC

17. Land sales edged down

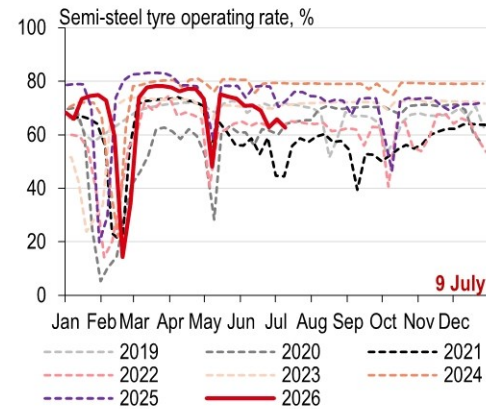


Source: Wind, HSBC

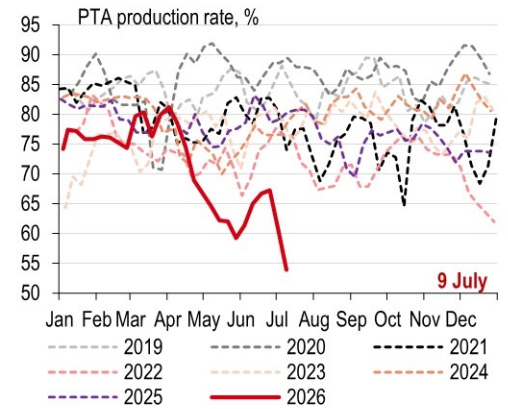
18. Planned construction area of land sold edged down



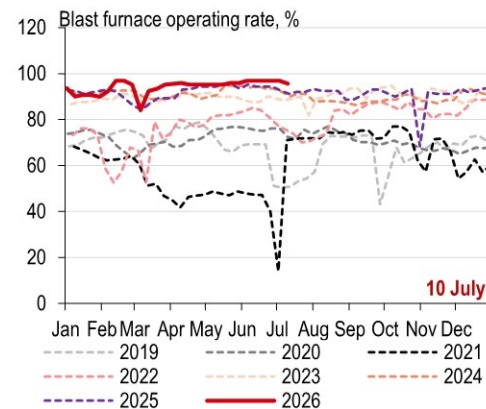
Source: Wind, HSBC

19. The semi-steel tyre operating rate moved down


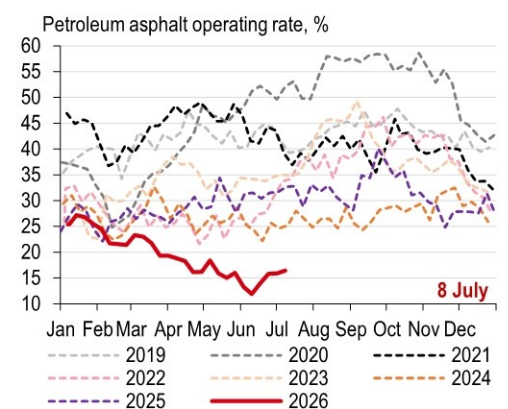
Source: Wind, HSBC

20. The PTA production rate slumped due to plant maintenance and weak demand


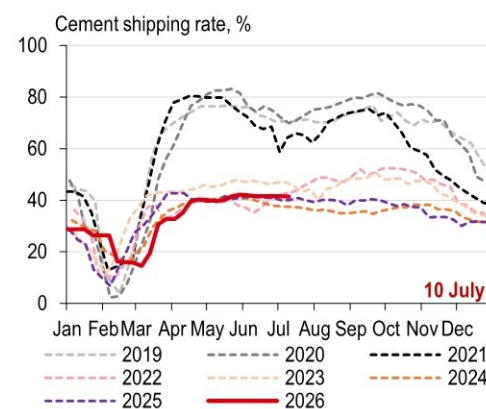
Source: Wind, HSBC

21. The blast furnace operating rate remained above historical levels


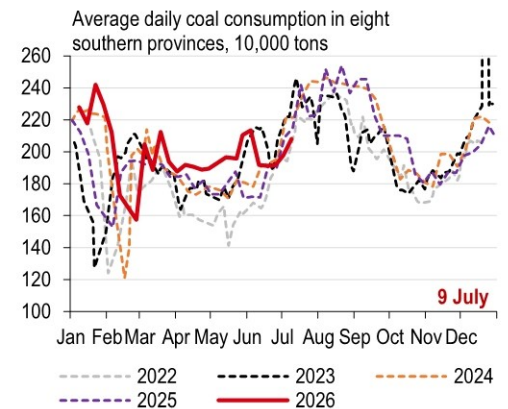
Source: Wind, HSBC

22. The petroleum asphalt operating rate ticked up


Source: Wind, HSBC

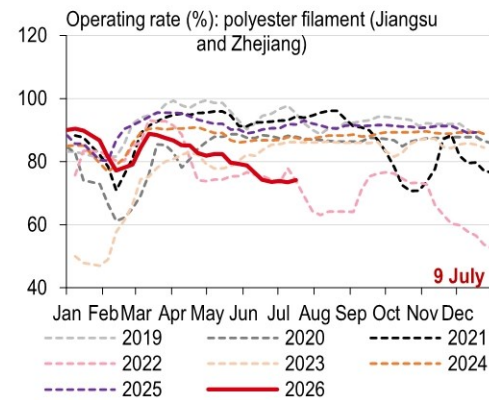
23. The cement shipping rate steadied


Source: Wind, HSBC

24. Coal consumption for eight major provinces edged up


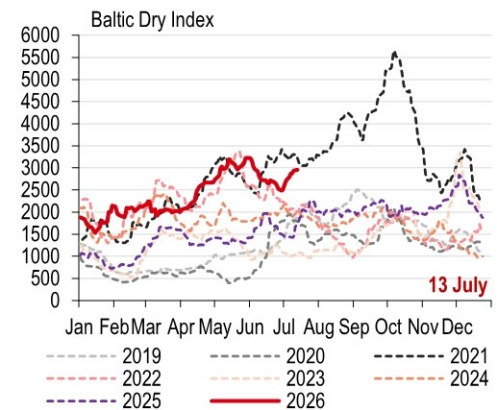
Source: Wind, HSBC

25. The operating rate of polyester filaments steadied



Source: Wind, HSBC

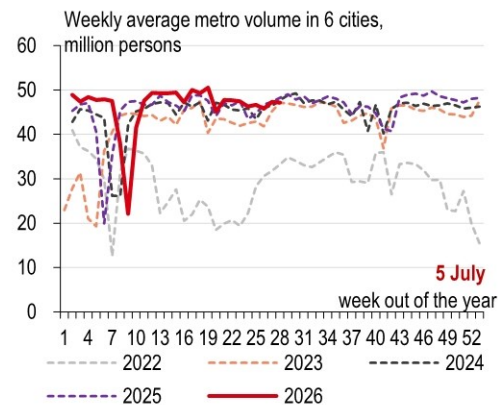
26. The Baltic Dry Index picked up



Source: Wind, HSBC

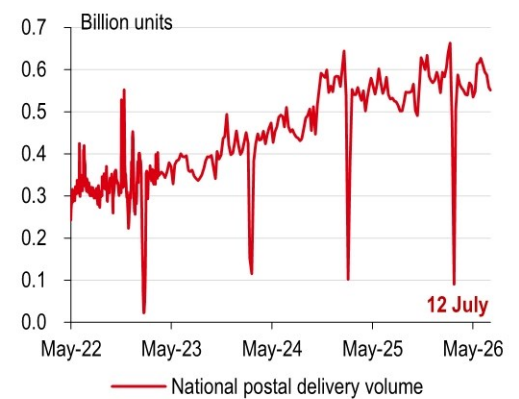
Travel and logistics

27. Metro volumes in large cities steadied



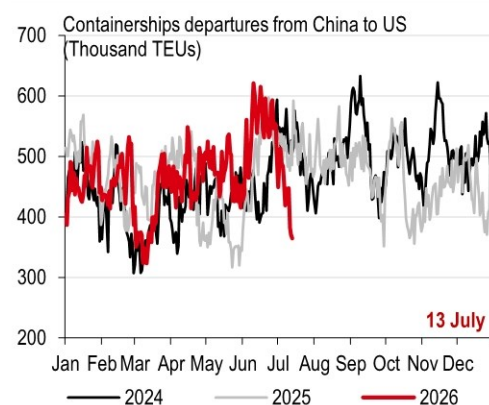
Source: Wind, HSBC; note: six cities include Beijing, Shanghai, Guangzhou, Shenzhen, Chengdu and Tianjin.

28. Postal delivery volumes edged down



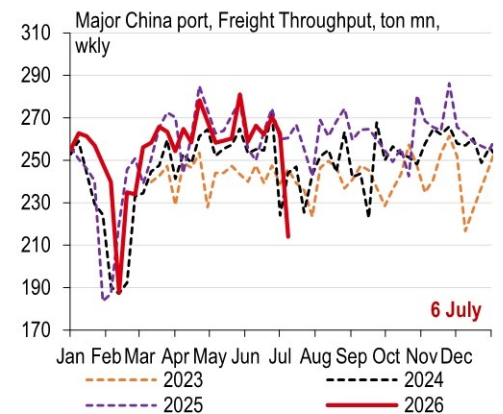
Source: Wind, HSBC

29. Container exports from China to the US edged down



Source: Bloomberg, HSBC

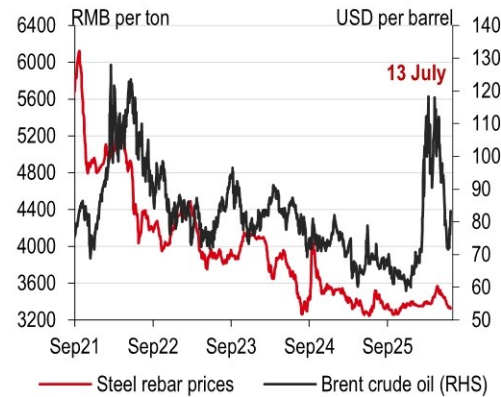
30. China's major ports' freight throughput edged down



Source: CEIC, HSBC; Note: Weekly beginning at Monday

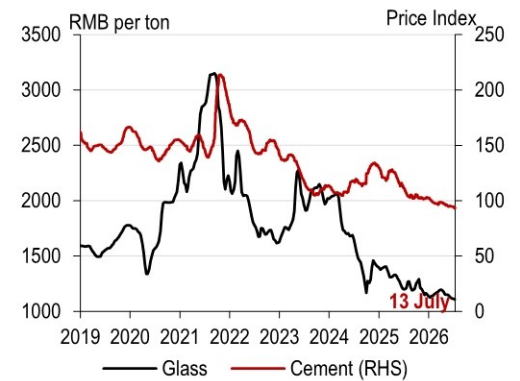
Inflation and policies

31. Crude oil prices picked up due to renewed tensions in the Middle East



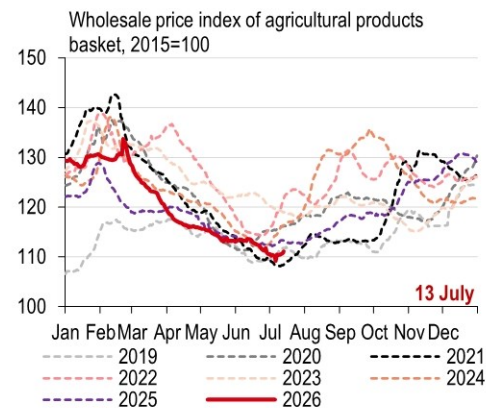
Source: Wind, HSBC

32. Cement prices and glass prices both edged down



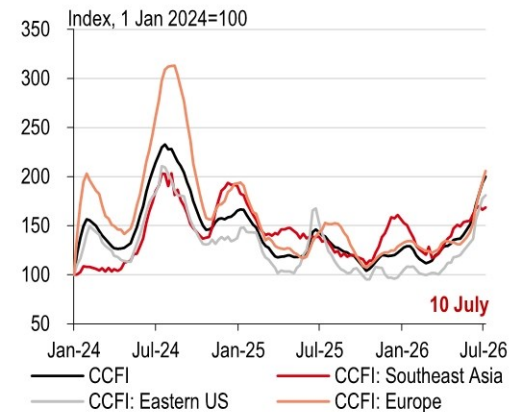
Source: Wind, HSBC

33. Agricultural product prices edged up seasonally



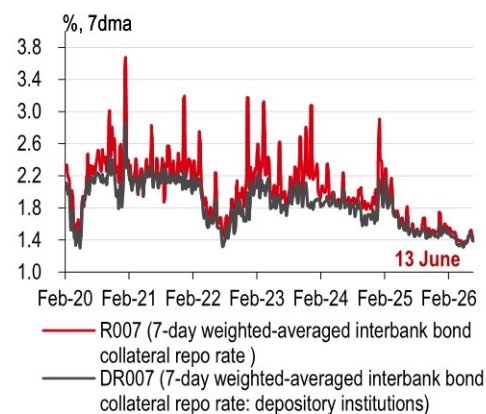
Source: Wind, HSBC

34. Container shipping costs have generally trended upward



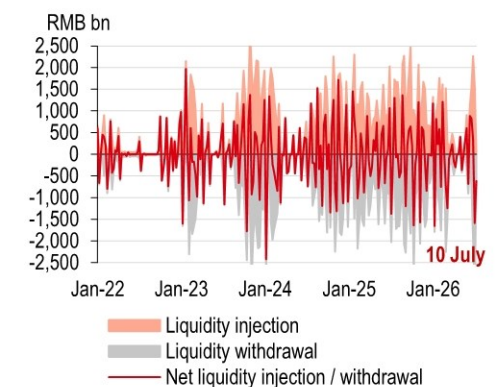
Source: Wind, HSBC

35. Interbank rates edged down



Source: Wind, HSBC

36. The PBOC made net withdrawals through OMOs last week



Source: Wind, HSBC

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